

» AFTER

France ruled its Asian colonies with an iron fist, quickly quashing any nascent signs of nationalism.

NATIONALISTS IN WAITING

Vietnamese opposition to French rule showed itself in **sporadic revolts** through the early 20th century. The ruthless oppression by the French colonial police forced most nationalists to operate in exile, including the young revolutionary **Ho Chi Minh**.

POWER VACUUM

Nazi Germany **took control of France** in June 1940, thereby drastically transforming the situation in French Indochina. The colonial administration there was cut off from support or reinforcement from Paris. Japan, fighting a war across the border in China, took the opportunity to **send troops into Indochina**.